

Michael Herbst

IT Operations, Systems Administration and Technical Support

Windows Server | Microsoft 365 and Entra ID | Infrastructure, Automation and Service Delivery

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Professional Summary

More than six years as the sole technical resource supporting proprietary .NET engineering software used across 270+ South African offices, with clients in Namibia, Botswana, Eswatini, Ireland and Australia. Owned the full technical estate at Civilsoft: Windows Server and VPS infrastructure, Microsoft 365 tenant administration at Global Administrator level, identity, endpoints, virtualisation, networks and databases. Combines that technical ownership with client support, bid preparation and commercial experience, a record of fixing recurring problems at the cause and clear handover documentation.

Core Capabilities

- **Infrastructure and platforms:** Windows Server and VPS, Proxmox VE, Hyper-V, networks, endpoints, backup, restore, disaster recovery, cPanel, hosting, domains, DNS.
- **Microsoft 365 and identity:** Tenant administration at Global Administrator level across Exchange Online, SharePoint Online, Teams and OneDrive; Active Directory, Microsoft Entra ID (formerly Azure Active Directory), Conditional Access, MFA, Intune, Defender and Group Policy.
- **Google Workspace:** Google Workspace administration, Google Admin console, Gmail, Drive, Meet and Groups.
- **Service delivery and enablement:** Freshdesk triage, prioritisation, escalation, resolution; onboarding, offboarding, runbooks, user guides and training.
- **Databases and reporting:** SQL Server, MySQL and Microsoft Access; database setup, maintenance, integrity checks, backup, restore and repair in Toad (Quest); custom report development in the applications' own report designers.
- **Automation:** PowerShell, Bash and Git for repeatable provisioning, file operations, scheduled tasks and SHA-256 file-integrity checks.
- **Commercial and compliance support:** Requirements, scopes, quotations, proposals, vendor evaluation, public-sector bids, MBD, CSD, PPPFA, POPIA-aware administration.

Professional Experience

Kouga Digital | Founder

May 2026–present | Jeffreys Bay, South Africa

- Run an independent solo practice covering IT, infrastructure, managed services, web development and digital marketing from scoping and quotation through delivery, revision and handover.
- Configured and solely administer Kouga Digital's Google Workspace Business environment, including ongoing maintenance.
- Linked deployment workflows to version control, preventing recurring duplicate hosting instances at the cause.
- Administer hosting, cPanel, domains, DNS and static deployments using production, security and handover checklists, readable configuration and Git-based version control.

Civilsoft Systems CC | Client Support Administrator (sole IT operations and infrastructure resource)

December 2019–May 2026 | St Francis Bay, Eastern Cape, South Africa

- Owned technical support and IT operations for proprietary .NET engineering software for bills of quantities, payment certificates, tender documents and project time and billing, used across 270+ South African offices and by clients in Namibia, Botswana, Eswatini, Ireland and Australia, over six years and five months of continuous service.

- Acted as the sole technical escalation point for Southern African and international software users, handling an estimated 10 to 30 support requests a day, and provided remote and on-site IT support to related companies.
- Won and onboarded a national engineering consultancy, then remained its sole contact as the account grew from 50 to approximately 300 licensed users.
- Provisioned and maintained Windows Server and VPS environments, including application deployment, monitoring, patching, access, backup, restore and disaster-recovery readiness.
- Administered Microsoft 365 tenants at Global Administrator level across Exchange Online, SharePoint Online, Teams and OneDrive, together with Active Directory, Entra ID, MFA, Conditional Access, Intune, licensing, groups, shared mailboxes, Group Policy and user lifecycle processes.
- Supported Proxmox VE, Hyper-V, networks and endpoints, including DNS, DHCP, VPN, firewalls, routing and structured cabling.
- Set up, maintained, troubleshooted and repaired the SQL Server and MySQL databases behind the company's cost-management and time-and-billing applications, working directly in Toad (Quest), Microsoft Access and the vendor's backend tools.
- Built, edited and repaired complex financial, engineering and project-management reports by writing SQL queries directly in the applications' developer settings, and configured custom flags and output formatting for bills of quantities, payment certificates and invoices.
- Ran Freshdesk triage, prioritisation, escalation, resolution and follow-up against agreed SLA targets, while maintaining runbooks, onboarding material, user guides and training content.
- Delivered training to non-technical users and secured approval for an updated video-training and user-guide programme.
- Solely compiled and submitted the company's public-sector bids and annual licence-renewal tenders to 15 public bodies, including three metropolitan municipalities, eight district and local municipalities, two provincial departments, SARAO and the South African Reserve Bank, meeting MBD, CSD and PPPFA requirements. Secured new sales, licence increases and recurring annual renewals through those submissions.

Teleray CC | Assistant Manager, promoted from Internal Sales

2018–2019 | Gqeberha, Eastern Cape, South Africa

- Combined technical B2B and retail sales with staff induction and training, inventory, trial-balance bookkeeping and marketing support.
- Held key-holder responsibility and ran day-to-day business operations in the owner's absence.

Irislink SA / The Media Genius SA | IT & Sales Consultant

2017 | Gqeberha, Eastern Cape, South Africa

- Supported regional deployment, configuration, product advice, sales support and end-user troubleshooting for OCR software and devices.

Earlier roles: Sales Manager, The Student Advisor (2018); Sales Consultant, Wayne Pheiffer Cycles (2018, temporary); Event DJ/MC and Sound Technician, Lutiek Promotions & Sound (2014–2015).

Certification and Professional Development

- CompTIA Security+ in progress
- TechSmith Snagit certification
- Working knowledge of ITIL service-management practice; active self-directed study in Azure, Google Cloud, Python and AI/LLM-assisted operational tooling

Education

- **University of Pretoria (2015–2017):** Studies toward B.Eng. Computer Engineering and B.Com. Law, not completed
- **St Dominic's College, Welkom (2014):** National Senior Certificate (IEB); 3rd in matric with full academic honours and five subject distinctions

Languages and Additional Information

- Languages: English, home language; Afrikaans, proficient; Sesotho, basic
- South African citizen; valid Code 08 driving licence; available immediately